

Calculate the opponent's best resistance

Thinking And Training

THE IDEA

A combination is only as strong as its answer to the strongest defense. Do not assume the opponent will capture a sacrificed piece or follow the most natural recapture. Search for checks, counterattacks, and declining the sacrifice.

WORKED EXAMPLE

You offer a bishop near the king, imagining a pawn capture that opens a file. The defender may instead move the king, exchange queens, or give check. Your line must survive those alternatives to be sound.

TRY IT BEFORE READING ON

What is a useful self-question after finding a promising attack?

ANSWER AND REASONING

If I were defending, what would I try to spoil this? Examine moves that change the nature of the position, not only the reply you hope to see.

TAKE THIS INTO YOUR NEXT GAME

Cooperate with your opponent in imagination by trying to defeat your own idea.